

example, 'Development' and 'Shipping' configurations. The Development configuration includes extra debugging info and is not optimized, while the Shipping configuration is highly optimized and lacks debugging info.

- **Supported Platforms:** Check if your project's settings are correctly configured for your target platform(s). Different platforms have different requirements and specifications, and it's essential to ensure your project settings match these.
- **Dependencies and Plugins:** Ensure all your project's dependencies are in order. This includes checking any plugins you might have used in your project.

Packaging process

The actual process of packaging your project is relatively straightforward:

- **Open your Project:** Launch Unreal Engine and open the project you want to package.
- **Select Packaging Settings:** Navigate to the 'File' menu, then select 'Package Project', followed by 'Packaging Settings'. This will open a new window where you can review and change your packaging settings as per your requirements.
- **Choose the Platform:** Go back to 'Package Project' and select your target platform(s). You can choose from options like Windows, Mac, Linux, iOS, Android, and others.
- **Select Output Folder:** Choose the location where you want the packaged project to be stored. Ensure you have enough storage space as packaged projects can often be significantly larger than the original project due to included assets and libraries.
- **Package the Project:** Once you've made your selections, click 'Package' to start the packaging process.

The engine will now start the process of compiling and packaging your project, which may take some time depending on the size and complexity of your project.

Testing your packaged project

After packaging your project, it's essential to test the executable on your target platform(s) to ensure everything is working correctly. During this process, you should check the following:

- The game launches correctly without any errors.
- All levels, assets, and functionalities are working as expected.
- The performance of the game is up to the mark.
- The packaged game behaves the same way as it did in the development environment.

Troubleshooting packaging issues

Occasionally, you may encounter issues during the packaging process. Unreal Engine provides comprehensive logs that can help you troubleshoot these issues. Here are some common problems and their solutions:

- **Missing Assets or Dependencies:** Ensure all assets are in

the correct directories and all dependencies are correctly configured in your project settings.

- **Platform-Specific Issues:** Each platform has specific requirements and limitations. Ensure you follow Unreal Engine's platform-specific documentation to address any such issues.
- **Unsupported Plugins or Libraries:** Some plugins or libraries may not be supported on all platforms. Be sure to check the compatibility of any plugins or third-party libraries you're using.
- **Build Configuration Problems:** Switching between build configurations may cause issues. Try recompiling your project with the desired build configuration before packaging.

Advanced packaging options

Unreal Engine 5 provides several advanced options to customize the packaging process:

- **Project Launcher:** The Project Launcher provides more granular control over the packaging process. It allows you to cook content by the map, meaning you can choose specific levels to include in the build, among other things.
- **Command Line Arguments:** Unreal Engine provides command line arguments for packaging projects. This can be particularly useful for automating the build process or when working with continuous integration/continuous deployment (CI/CD) systems.
- **Custom Packaging Scripts:** You can write custom scripts to automate the packaging process, giving you the flexibility to do things like automatically increasing the version number, cleaning up old builds, or uploading builds to a server.



Distributing your packaged project

Once your project is packaged and tested, it's ready for distribution. How you distribute your project depends on your target platform and audience. For example, if you're targeting PC, you might distribute your game through digital platforms like Steam, Epic Games Store, or GOG. For mobile platforms, you'd likely use the Google Play Store for Android or the App Store for iOS. 